RDoc stops processing comments if it finds a comment line starting with #--. This can be used to separate external from internal comments or to stop a comment from being associated with a method, class, attribute, or module. Documenting can be turned back on by starting a line with the comment #++:

```
# Extract the age and calculate the
# date of birth.
#--
# FIXME: fails if the birthday falls on February 29th, or if the person
# was born before epoch and the installed Ruby doesn't support negative time_t
#++
# The DOB is returned as a Time object.
#--
# But should probably change to use Date.

def get_dob(person)
  ...
end
```

Hyperlinks

Names of classes, source files, and any method names containing an underscore or preceded by a hash character are automatically hyperlinked from comment text to their description.

In addition, hyperlinks starting with http:, mailto:, ftp:, and www: are recognized. An HTTP URL that references an external image file is converted into an inline img tag. Hyperlinks starting with link: are assumed to refer to local files whose paths are relative to the --op directory, where output files are stored.

Hyperlinks can also be of the form label[url], where the label is used in the displayed text and url is used as the target. If the label contains multiple words, surround it in braces: {two words}[url].

Lists

Lists are typed as indented paragraphs with the following:

- As asterisk (*) or hyphen (-) for bullet lists
- A digit followed by a period for numbered lists
- An uppercase or lowercase letter followed by a period for alpha lists

For example, you could produce something like the previous text with this:

```
#  Lists are typed as indented paragraphs with
#  * a * or - (for bullet lists),
#  * a digit followed by a period for
#    numbered lists,
#  * an uppercase or lowercase letter followed
#    by a period for alpha lists.
```

Note how subsequent lines in a list item are indented to line up with the text in the element's first line.

Labeled lists (sometimes called *description lists*) are typed using square brackets for the label:

```
#  [cat]    Small domestic animal
#  [+cat+]  Command to copy standard input
```